Cameras Roll in Venice for the Sequel to 'Upgraded'

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Filming is underway in Venice for "Upgraded 2," the **sequel** to the 2024 romantic comedy "Upgraded." Camila Mendes returns as Ana Santos, and Leslie Bibb will star alongside her. Bibb's role is not yet known.

In the first film, Ana is an **intern** at a New York City **auction house**. She pretends to hold a higher job after she is upgraded to first class on her flight to London. During the flight, she impresses William, a wealthy young Englishman played by Archie Renaux, from the art world. The **sequel** is described as a modern-day "Cinderella" tale.

Cameras started rolling in Venice on October 21. In the **sequel**, Ana is seemingly seeking to make her mark at the Venice **Biennale**, described as the world's oldest contemporary art fair. Becca Gleason is directing the **sequel**, replacing Carlson Young. Luke Roberts and Justin Matthews also wrote the **screenplay**.

Filming has taken place on the terrace of Ca' Giustinian, the **Biennale** headquarters. After 12 days in Venice, filming will move to Rome for 33 more days, according to Italy for Movies.

Word Treasure

intern -- A person who works at a job for a short time to learn about it.

auction house -- A place where special items are sold to the person who offers the most money.

sequel -- A new movie that continues the story of an earlier movie.

screenplay -- The written story and words that actors use to make a movie.

Biennale -- A large art fair in Venice.

Background you need

A sequel is a new movie that continues the story of an earlier movie.

In the first movie, Ana was an intern at an auction house, a place where art and other special items are sold to the person who offers the most money.

In the new movie, she tries to make her mark at the Venice Biennale, a large art fair in Venice, Italy.

Break it down

WHO: Camila Mendes as Ana Santos, Leslie Bibb, and director Becca Gleason.
WHAT: Filming is underway in Venice for Upgraded 2, the sequel to Upgraded.
WHERE: In Venice, including the terrace of Ca' Giustinian, the Biennale headquarters, before filming moves to Rome.
WHY: Ana is seeking to make her mark at the Venice Biennale in the new story.

Why it matters

It can remind you that starting small, like an intern, does not stop you from aiming for a bigger goal.

Test what you remember

1. Who returns as Ana Santos in the sequel?

- (A) Becca Gleason
- (B) Leslie Bibb
- (C) Camila Mendes
- (D) Carlson Young

2. What was Ana's job in the first film?

- (A) A singer in Venice
- (B) A teacher in London
- (C) A director in Rome
- (D) An intern at a New York City auction house

3. How did Ana pretend to hold a higher job in the first film?

- (A) She won an art prize
- (B) She was upgraded to first class on her flight to London
- (C) She moved to Rome
- (D) She directed a movie

4. Who is directing the sequel?

- (A) Becca Gleason
- (B) Justin Matthews
- (C) Luke Roberts
- (D) Carlson Young

5. Where will filming move after 12 days in Venice?

- (A) New York City
- (B) London
- (C) Paris
- (D) Rome

6. What is the Venice Biennale described as in the story?

- (A) A music festival
- (B) A new movie studio
- (C) The world's oldest contemporary art fair
- (D) A famous tennis tournament

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):